CANBERK VARLI

SOFTWARE ENGINEER
+1 415-769-8292 | canberkvarli@gmail.com | Berkeley, CA | LinkedIn | GitHub | Portfolio

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Lead | **ActorRise** >> Remote | [live]
February 2026 – Present

• Built and launched AI-powered acting career platform, bootstrapped solo to 300+ users and paying monthly subscribers through a self-built marketing and outreach funnel
• Developed AI ScenePartner, an interactive rehearsal tool that lets actors run scenes conversationally to practice and memorize lines faster
• Built RAG-based semantic search with vector embeddings and pgvector cosine similarity across 12,000+ monologues, combining vector and trigram text search for optimal relevance
• Built production ETL pipeline automating web scraping, monologue extraction, AI content analysis, and batch embedding generation; deployed full-stack Next.js/FastAPI app with Supabase Auth and CI/CD

Software Engineer | **Prevail Legal AI** >> San Francisco, CA
Sept 2021 – May 2024

• Built advanced transcript search and highlighting system using CSS Custom Highlight API with real-time keyword matching, enabling attorneys to navigate 10,000+ line transcripts 3x faster during deposition review sessions
• Developed transcript review toolbar UI with flag filtering and custom styling controls using Stimulus.js and RESTful APIs, supporting 6 user permission levels and processing 1,000+ deposition sessions monthly across enterprise law firms
• Built organization member management system with role-based access control using Ruby on Rails on AWS infrastructure, supporting 50+ enterprise law firms with secure multi-tenant architecture ensuring regulatory compliance
• Implemented transcript-video synchronization with millisecond-precision highlighting, reducing case preparation time by 40% for legal professionals reviewing deposition footage and transcript content

Software Engineering Intern | **MICROSOFT** >> Istanbul, Turkey
Summer 2017

• Developed Xamarin cross-platform mobile app demonstrating viability of unified iOS/Android development to senior leadership, leading to adoption across 3 internal teams

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frameworks: React Native, Ruby on Rails, React.js, Next.js, Redux, Express.js, Expo, Prisma, FastAPI
Languages: TypeScript, Python, Ruby, JavaScript
AI/ML: LangChain, LangGraph, ChromaDB, Pinecone
Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Supabase
DevOps & Cloud: AWS, Docker, GitHub Actions, Firebase, Render, Kubernetes

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering | Bahcesehir University >> Istanbul, Turkey *2014-2018*
Private Pilot Training | Airwin Flight School >> Budapest, Hungary *2019*

KEY PROJECTS

fullcircle – Wellness Community App | [App Store Live]
2024 – 2025 | React Native, Expo, TypeScript, Firebase Firestore

• Built end-to-end iOS wellness community app with real-time messaging, Stripe/IAP payments, push notifications, and location-based community discovery

VOLUNTEER WORK

Actor | Inferno Theater >> Berkeley, CA
2022 – Present

• Performed in four productions and led two contemporary plays in Berkeley.